

ARES Sync - Technician Installation and Teacher Handoff

Use this guide when an ARES technician or ARES Advocate helps a teacher install and enroll ARES Sync. Complete the installation at the school, with normal Internet available and at least one school network named **ARES** or **ARES2** in range.

What ARES Sync does

ARES Sync collects the school's scheduled ARES usage-summary file from the local ARES server. It stores the file privately on the phone until validated Internet is available, then sends it securely to ARES Education. It does not require daily teacher action.

ARES Sync does **not** read the teacher's messages, contacts, photos, documents, or browsing history. On older Android versions, Android may label the Wi-Fi permission as Location; ARES Sync does not use it to determine the phone's physical location.

Before visiting the teacher

- Confirm the school server has passed the ARES usage-collection server installation and verification procedure.
- Confirm the canonical school name and ARES-S00XX ID.
- Confirm the school has an ARES Advocate or other named support contact.
- Bring the official setup address: <https://areseducation.org/phone-setup/>.
- Do not send staff passwords, administrator keys, device credentials, or stored enrollment data to the teacher.

What you need at the school

- The teacher's Android phone, with sufficient battery and storage.
- Normal Internet through mobile data or Internet-capable Wi-Fi.
- ARES or ARES2 within range.
- Access to the protected ARES staff enrollment portal.
- The teacher's permission to install the app and approve the required Android prompts.

1. Generate the one-time installation key

- 1 On your own trusted device, open the protected ARES staff enrollment portal.
- 2 Sign in with the shared staff password.
- 3 Search for the school and confirm both its canonical name and ARES-S00XX ID.
- 4 Select **Generate one-time code**.
- 5 Keep the displayed XXXX-XXXX code private and use it immediately on the teacher's phone.
- 6 Sign out of the staff portal when finished.

The teacher guide calls this an **installation key**. The app and staff portal may call it an **enrollment code**. They are the same one-time value. It works for only one phone enrollment. Never record it in GitHub, a shared document, or an unsecured message.

If the portal reports that an unused code already exists, do not replace it automatically. Replace it only when the earlier code is lost or must be revoked.

2. Download and install ARES Sync

- 1 Keep the phone connected to normal Internet.
- 2 In Chrome, open <https://areseducation.org/phone-setup/>.
- 3 Select **Start phone setup**, then **Download ARES Sync**.
- 4 Open `ares-sync.apk` from the browser's Downloads list or notification.
- 5 If Android asks which installer to use, select **Android installer**.
- 6 If Android blocks installation from the browser or Files app, open **Settings**, enable **Allow from this source** for that app, return to the installer, and continue.
- 7 If Android recommends an app scan, allow the scan. Continue only after it passes.
- 8 If Play Protect presents a different warning, use **More details** or the equivalent and install only after confirming the APK came from the official ARES page.
- 9 Never disable Play Protect globally.
- 10 Select **Install**, then **Open**.

Android wording varies by phone. Stop and contact ARES technical support if Android offers no safe path to install the official APK.

3. Enroll the phone

- 1 In ARES Sync, type at least two letters of the school name and select **Find school**.
- 2 Select the exact canonical school. Verify the school with the teacher before continuing.
- 3 Enter the eight-character installation key. The app inserts the hyphen automatically.
- 4 Select **Enroll this phone**.

If enrollment fails, do not generate multiple keys blindly. Recheck the selected school, Internet connection, and code. A used code cannot be reused.

4. Approve automatic school-network access

After enrollment, ARES Sync starts one-time Wi-Fi setup. Approve each prompt that appears:

- 1 Allow ARES Sync to suggest Wi-Fi networks.
- 2 Allow **Nearby Wi-Fi devices**. On older Android versions, allow the equivalent Location permission.
- 3 Approve a connection to ARES or ARES2 when Android asks.
- 4 Allow notifications when requested.

ARES Sync may try both ARES2 and ARES. Wait for it to finish. A successful setup returns automatically to the main screen.

5. Verify the completed installation

Do not leave until the main screen shows all of the following:

- the correct school name;
- the next approved collection date;
- **Everything is ready. No action required.**
- **Usage data: up to date.**
- a status stating that automatic school Wi-Fi setup is complete.

If the next collection date is already past or the app reports a pending collection during a new rollout, stop and verify the production schedule before proceeding.

6. Explain the system to the teacher

Use this short explanation:

ARES Sync normally works in the background. On scheduled dates it collects a small usage-summary file from the school ARES server. It may briefly use ARES or ARES2 for that local collection. When the phone later has normal Internet, it sends the file securely to ARES Education. You do not need to open the app every day.

Tell the teacher:

- Keep the app installed and keep notifications allowed.
- Keep the phone's normal Internet Wi-Fi networks saved.
- Approve ARES or ARES2 if Android asks again at a different school access point.
- **Usage data: up to date** means there is nothing waiting to send.
- **Waiting to send when Internet is available** is normal; connect to normal Internet and allow the app time to send.
- Contact the school's ARES Advocate if the app says **needs attention**, repeatedly asks for help, shows the wrong school, or does not return to the ready state.
- A new phone or a reinstallation requires a new one-time installation key.

Mobile-data guidance

The uploaded item is the school's CSV usage-summary file, not the 6 MB installer. The server currently rejects any usage file larger than 2 MiB. Actual files are expected to be much smaller, but representative production files must be measured during rollout.

Until measurements are recorded, budget **5 MB per scheduled collection**. This covers the 2 MiB technical ceiling, HTTPS overhead, and one full retry. With six scheduled collections, a conservative annual allowance is **30 MB per teacher phone**, excluding initial app download and future app updates.

Whenever possible, let pending files upload over ordinary Internet Wi-Fi. ARES Sync may also use mobile data when that is the phone's validated Internet connection.

Installation record

Record only non-secret rollout information:

- School name and ID: _____
- Teacher or assigned phone: _____
- Phone model and Android version: _____
- Installation date: _____
- Technician / ARES Advocate: _____
- Next collection date shown: _____
- Final ready state confirmed: Yes / No
- Notes or follow-up: _____

Do not record the one-time installation key, staff password, device credential, or other secret.

Quick troubleshooting

Download will not start

- Confirm normal Internet is working.
- Reload the official setup page.
- Check browser download permissions and free storage.

Android will not install the APK

- Confirm the APK came from the official ARES page.
- Allow installation from the browser or Files app being used.
- Complete the recommended scan.
- Do not disable Play Protect globally.

School is not found or enrollment fails

- Confirm normal Internet is available.
- Search using only part of the school name.
- Verify the canonical school and ID in the staff portal.
- Generate a new key only if the earlier key was used, lost, or intentionally revoked.

Automatic Wi-Fi setup does not finish

- Confirm ARES or ARES2 is in range.
- Allow Nearby Wi-Fi devices and network suggestions.
- Approve the Android request for ARES or ARES2.
- Use **Connect to school Wi-Fi** as the manual fallback, then return to ARES Sync.

A pending file does not send

- Connect the phone to validated normal Internet.
- Open ARES Sync once and wait several minutes.
- If **needs attention** remains, record the non-secret status message and contact ARES technical support.